

No. 738, April 2011

# Vertigo

**Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club  
Wellington Section**

[www.nzalpine.wellington.net.nz](http://www.nzalpine.wellington.net.nz)

[www.facebook.com/nzacwellington](https://www.facebook.com/nzacwellington)

View towards the summit of  
"Mt Forbes #2" from high camp  
Image courtesy of Terry Crippen



WELCOME TO THE FIRST issue of the new look Vertigo. I hope that the bright and fresh new look will encourage you all to send me your trip reports so that I can keep the newsletter full of great stories and photos. You can contact me at [newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz](mailto:newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz) Cheers!

Stephen Minchin, Editor

## Next section night: 4 April, 2011

### Escalada Latino, by Derek Cheng

IN DECEMBER 2007, Kiwi climber Derek Cheng got bored of working, and decided that living in a van for four months would be a far more productive way to spend his time. Followed by a month in Arapiles.

But that wasn't enough, so he packed his harness, shoes and some other things together and shot off to Latin America for the best part of two years in search of salsa, empanadas, and ruins. And some rock faces along the fairly lengthy rocky spine that is the Andes. And some high altitude snow and ice in Bolivia and Peru. And some giant mosquitoes next to limestone giants in Cuba.

Along the way he discovered some remote places, awesome people, and that travel and climbing are very complementary.



Velle Encantado

Club nights are at Turnbull House, on the first unimpeded Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meetings and talks start at 8.00 pm with club business and tea & coffee afterwards. Meet for dinner at the Backbencher public bar at 6.30 pm and on to Turnbull House at 7.30 pm for a catch up.

## The Wellington Section Photo Competition is Coming!

Submit your best photos to see them on the big screen, get feedback from photography experts, vote on this year's best shots, and be in to win great prizes from our sponsors.

A panel of first-rate photographers / pho-connoisseurs will present a selection of the best shots for the audience to choose the winners. The competition will be held at the June club night (Monday 13 June).

Entries can be submitted from April 15th until May 22nd.

1) Pick out your best pictures for the following categories:

- Alpine Activity: climbing, skiing, whatever you do up high
- Alpine General: scenery and views that make you want to come back
- Alpine Nature: the little gems of beauty along the way
- Rockclimbing: hardest moves, slickest lines
- Photo Journalism: the shot that tells a story
- Humour: whatever gets you a laugh

2) Fill out an entry form (available on our website or by email) and send it to [wgtphotocomp@gmail.com](mailto:wgtphotocomp@gmail.com)

If entering slides or prints, please scan them first – we need all entries to be in digital format. Maximum of three entries per category per person.

For further info contact Hinrich Schaefer on (021) 298 6894 or at [wgtphotocomp@gmail.com](mailto:wgtphotocomp@gmail.com)

The Banff Centre presents  
2010 / 2011

# BANFF MOUNTAIN FILM FESTIVAL WORLD TOUR

To view the Banff trailer click here:

<http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vq4Q6DrggFI>

The World's  
Best Mountain Films

[www.banffmountainfestival.ca](http://www.banffmountainfestival.ca)



NEW ZEALAND  
ALPINE CLUB



The Banff Centre  
inspiring creativity

## Wellington

Tuesday 10 May *and* Thursday 12 May  
6.30pm start time  
The Paramount Theatre,  
25 Courtenay Place

**Tickets:**  
\$18 NZAC members \$20 non-members  
Available from The Paramount box office  
and at NZAC section nights.



# Banff Mountain Film Festival Wellington's 2011 Programme

The Paramount Cinema, 25 Courtenay Place

## Tuesday 10th May: "Wet"



### Dream result

(Winner "People's Choice Award for Radical Reels")

A group of top kayakers and friends are driven by passion to explore the limits of possibility. Expeditions to Norway and a quest for waterfalls throughout Argentina and the US are all part of the program in Dream Result — so hang on for the ride!

### Crossing the ditch

Spanning 2200 kilometres between Australia and New Zealand, the Tasman Sea is one of the world's deadliest and most treacherous oceans. No one had ever successfully navigated the Tasman by kayak, although many had tried. Crossing the Ditch tells the story of two young Australians, James Castrission and Justin Jones, who battle ten-metre towering waves, massive storms, shark-filled seas, and strong currents to conquer the Tasman Sea.



### Oseven

A group of friends meet up at a chalet in Chamonix Mont Blanc to recount their extreme sport experiences. OSeven is based on Sigmund Freud's theory that "happiness is a child's dream fulfilled in maturity."

### Easter rises

(Winner "Best film on mountain sports")

The Kamchatka Peninsula in the Russian Far East may as well be the end of the earth. Its enormously wild landscape is swarming with bugs and bears and threaded with rivers full of massive mouse-eating trout. In the stunning film Eastern Rises, fishing is poetry, Bigfoot lurks in the fog, and fishermen risk life and limb in decommissioned Cold War helicopters to explore rivers that have never been fished before.



To view the Banff trailer click here:

<http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vq4Q6DrggFI>



The Banff Centre  
inspiring creativity



## Thursday 12th May: "Dry"



### Follow me

You're at the head of a trail you have never ridden before. With a knowing look, a friend turns to you and says, "Just follow me!" Depending on who says it makes a pretty big difference for what lies ahead, but whether it's a good idea or not, we almost always drop in. From sending giant step-downs to high-speed trails, it's always better to share the ride.

### The Asgard project

(Winner "Award crest")

The Asgard Project follows Leo Houlding's ambitious project to make a first free ascent of the North Tower of the incredible Mount Asgard on Baffin Island deep in the Arctic. Houlding teams up with fellow big wall climber Stanley Leary, and the duo hopes to make a wingsuit descent from the summit. Arriving late in the season, the trip soon begins to go wrong. After a spectacular arrival skydiving over Mount Asgard, conditions turn against the team, so that just reaching the base of the climb becomes a massive challenge.



### As it happens

Renan and Corey Bradshaw "go rogue" and file video dispatches from their attempt at the first ascent of Nepal's 6,000 meter Tawoche Himal. The film takes these individual pieces and ties them together in one story that lets a challenging trip unfold as it happens.

### Living the dream

For most of the last six years, Renan Ozturk has been a traveling vagabond following his passion for rock climbing. This existence involved sleeping outside in wild places, hitching rides, living on little, draining his bank account, and occasionally, dumpster diving. Now a little more domesticated, Renan shows us he is still living his dream every day.



### Second nature

An exploration of the abstract and the extreme, Second Nature is an examination of the natural boundaries of the human body. Noah Sakamoto, Patrick Rizzo and J.M. Duran star as the test subjects as they wield skateboards and vintage suits to race down the roads of the High Sierras in California.

### Fly or die

Cutting edge climber Dean Potter is innovating climbing for the future: the Base Free Solo. By combining free solo climbing and base jumping, Dean is on a quest to master the various disciplines that lead up to this bold evolution of the sport. Note that while this film screened at Reel Rock in late 2010, this extended version manages to be even more bonkers.



To view the Banff trailer click here:

<http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vq4Q6DrqgFI>

[www.banffmountainfestival.ca](http://www.banffmountainfestival.ca)

streamed on 100% recycled paper

The Banff Centre  
inspiring creativity

# Baring Head Rock Hop Results

THE 2011 BARING HEAD Rock Hop was a great day out. There were 33 entrants who endured some poor weather in the morning however things steadily improved during the day.

Here are the results:

## Expert Male:

1st place – Zac Orme, 809pts  
2nd place – Tyler Fleury, 521pts  
3rd place – Dan Mackay, 508pts

## Expert Female:

1st place – Amie Jones, 165pts  
2nd place – Esther Packard, 133pts  
3rd place – Kate Sinclair, 78pts

## Junior Male:

1st place – Josiah Jacobson-Grocott, 500pts

## Endurance Male:

1st place – Tom Hoyle, 65.5pts  
2nd place – Clark Alston, 55.5pts  
3rd place – Chris Worthington, 30.25pts

## Endurance Female:

1st place – Briar Dods, 8.5pts  
2nd place = – Gina Butson, 4.5pts  
2nd place = – Siobhan Murray, 4.5pts

A huge thank you to all of the volunteers who made the day possible – Kristin Foley, Robin Maxwell, Dan Pringle all did a fantastic job.

And of course the day wouldn't have been the success it was without the generous support of the event's sponsors – Bivouac, Marvelox, Tools of the Adventure, Cactus, and Chalky Digits.



Ivan on the OTGDY Wall - Photo © 2011 Pete McGregor





Climber on the Low Traverse West Wall - Photo © 2011 | Pete McGregor



Climber on the Seaward Boulder - Photo © 2011 | Pete McGregor

# The Mt Forbes Project, February 2011

## Terry Crippen & Angela Minto

VARIOUS REASONS CAN BE invented for deciding on what climbs to undertake as part of one's summer down south. Last year the two of us were casually looking at a small scale map of the South Island; Mt Forbes (at 2583m up the Godley Valley) was noted and, seeing it was someones dad's name, it was decided we had better climb it. So, as one does nowadays with digital maps, we entered Mt Forbes into Freshmap and two other Mt Forbes popped up – so now we had three to climb! Thus the Mt Forbes Project was born.

We gave ourselves four to five weeks to accomplish this, since while the original Mt Forbes would be straightforward being up the Godley Valley, the other two were in Fiordland, one above First Arm in Doubtful Sound (1311m, Mt Forbes #2) and the third on Resolution Island (930m, Mt Forbes #3). We expected these two would be more of an undertaking due to Fiordland's weather and access, so we planned for a 20+ day trip for them.

A lot of research was undertaken to try and find out about the two Fiordland areas. No one had any information or knowledge about Mt Forbes #2, but we found out that Mt Forbes #3 was going to be a breeze, thanks to DoC's predator control programme on Resolution Island.

For Mt Forbes #1, we first attempted it via McKinnon Stream up the Godley Valley. On gaining the glacier at the head of the valley we found the icefall to be completely impassable this summer; multiple huge crevasses and towering seracs greeted us. Time was spent attempting to find a route through but it was impossible so we had to admit defeat and retreat. Not a good start to the project. A couple of days later we were camped up Separation Stream, the next side valley up the Godley. We were successful

on this route via the Ballium Snowfield. One down, two to go.

Getting out down the Godley and back to the vehicle was not without its problems. Rain and wind had set in overnight and Separation Stream became uncrossable. Fitzgerald Stream up valley was also impassable, so shelter in Godley Hut was cut off. Nothing for it but to set up the tent and wait it out. Two days later, with breakfast consisting of one biscuit each with a dollop of butter, jam, and marmite, we managed to get across Separation Stream and back to the vehicle. By this stage we were suitably overdue and a SAR operation had been initiated. Fortunately action had not progressed past the paperwork stage since the Tekapo police rightly assumed we would be safe and just sitting it out. We got (favourable) write-ups in the Timaru Herald and Wairarapa Times-Age!

For the Fiordland Forbes a fair bit of time was spent organizing things in Te Anau; mountain radio, float plane, helicopter, and discussing our project with DoC. DoC gave us permission to use their facilities (including locked hut) on Resolution Island – so Forbes #3

was going to be very straightforward. Loaded up with 20 days of food and gear we floatplaned into First Arm, welcomed by a pod of dolphins. Our planned route for Mt Forbes #2 from our base camp on the water's edge was a direct but very steep typical Fiordland spur up to a high basin directly underneath the summit.



View down McKinnon Stream

The next few days, besides enduring the rain and sandflies (no mosquitoes though), were spent progressively putting up a route through the very steep bush, scrub and bluffs; plentiful use of loppers and pruning saw was involved here, returning each evening to base camp. Progress at times was exceptionally slow but eventually it was time to head right up and



put in a lightweight high camp. Once above the scrubline travel was relatively easy and camp was set up on relatively flat, non rocky, dryish ground. From this camp the summit was a very enjoyable scramble on coarse gained rock in perfectly fine weather. From what we had researched we assumed that no one else had bothered to climb this summit from sea level. There was no summit cairn on top, so we had to build one and leave a note.

Back down at base camp the next day it was onto the mountain radio, contacting the helicopter operator, breaking camp, then a late afternoon transfer to Duck Cove on

Resolution Island. Forbes #3 was going to be more or less just a walk; easy grassy tops, and a predator trap track right to the summit. Not a super-highway though – quite rough tracks. And a cosy little hut for our base. Sandfly free accommodation this time plus a lot of fresh fruit and vegetables brought in via chopper to compliment our excessive amount of food (three 20L drums). At one stage a yacht sheltering from the weather offloaded fresh blue cod and cray-

fish onto us – we eagerly got rid of some of our chocolate in exchange.

With the network of predator control tracks Forbes #3 was successfully ascended as part of a long day circuit over the tops on the eastern side of the island. Project accomplished with days to spare! We made use of these in the centre of the island, investigating the sometimes rocky, sometimes swampy, open scrub covered landscape and summits. Our trip back to Te Anau was by floatplane a couple of days earlier to enable us to get out before the next period of continued rain and to plan our next week or so of climbing activities. In total we had

15 days for Forbes #2 and #3, all but four being wet. Our boots stayed wet the whole time. We dosed ourselves up weeks in advance and on the trip with Marmite, and this seemed to make the sandflies less inclined to bite.

So for any of you thinking about what to do for a trip – dream up some interesting unusual reason or idea and go for it!



View of first Arm from near Mt Forbes #2 summit



View of first Arm from near Mt Forbes #2 summit

# Earnslaw (Pikiratakahi) – Sir William Peak

## Nina Sawicki

WE ONLY JUST GOT through Christchurch airport before the big shake!

February 22 was a day etched in the history of New Zealand and was the day that brought Russell Shanks (Scotland), Mike Prijma (NZAC Australia), and Nina Sawicki and Kevin Patterson (NZAC Wellington) together at Christchurch airport at about 11.30am. After some introductory hugs and the usual “do they snore?” and other silent ponderings, we left Christchurch shortly after 11.55, some fifty minutes before the city trembled under the 6.3 but shallow and close quake. Russell was driving as we approached Ashburton and did wonder about the source of the invisible road-works as the car rocked a bit on a long straight stretch. Later of course in Queenstown and via texts we realised the devastation we had just missed.

**Day 1:** The long slog up to Esquilant Bivy (four person hut).

UNMISTAKELY THIS IS THE day with the most grunt from the Rees Valley at 450m up to 2250m at Esquilant Bivy (note incorrect elevation on the map at 2150m) carrying four to five days of food plus alpine gear. We started off at 9.30am and did not get there until just after midnight. Our start was hampered by forgetting an essential piece of food left in the fridge at the Glenorchy Back-Packers, and our ginger footed non-kiwis who did not like getting their feet wet. Thinking of Nina’s culinary delights, Kevin honourably dashed back for the food and pretty much caught up with Mike and Russell as they vainly attempted to keep their feet dry over numerous river crossings and muddy bogs. I have to say for a wet-footed “Kiwised” English lass, restraining laughter was a challenge.

Although it had rained the day before, the river level had gone down and crossing was straightforward. Kevin had sourced the Otago Regional Council website which provides current river flow and is invaluable because there have been several deaths crossing this river. After the river crossing – plus negotiating bulls and electric fences – the track climbs gently up through forest to the basin at 1000m, passing the somewhat decrepit old Earnslaw Hut en route.



The obvious track that climbs through the scree and rock band starts above the basin at about 1400m and involves mainly straightforward rock scrambling, a route that leads you to the

lower portion of the glacier at about 2000m. By this time it was late in the day and we were tiring slightly and I had probably not eaten enough. Kevin went ahead on the glacier scouring a route ahead noting that the ice was quite hard. We had a short break and fitted our crampons before the crossing of the Birley Glacier. I found the ice very hard and seemed to lose footing. Instead of checking my crampon placement, I soldiered on but did not feel particularly stable on my pins. I slipped and slid some distance down the glacier. Of course, I had not checked my crampon fitting! Fortunately the ice was rutted and I knew I would be able to get some hand or foot-hold somehow, the axe being pretty useless. The repeated practice of a self-arrest body position cannot be overstated! A meticulous search by Kevin found my crampon. It reminded me of Don French's search and rescue in my bed for my lost contact lens.

Soon we were on our way across the glacier which involved tricky navigation and some ice-gymnastics, and reached Wright Col at midnight and the Bivy at about 12.15am. Mike had an interesting encounter in a crevasse but was able to climb out with some pack-hauling. The moonlight across to the Richardson Mountains was spectacular but mutterings of such majestic beauty fell on the deaf stomachs of some



anonymous males in the group. Once we had found water which was elusive and frozen, I produced a hot meal and we were in bed by 2.00am.

## **Day 2: Sloth and Sleep**

MUCH NEEDED: SAY NO more. The weather, as predicted, was poor and with snow and rain falling overnight and a freeze.

## **Day 3: Attempt on Sir William**

RAIN TURNED TO SNOW down to 2100m overnight and as the route guide cautions about early morning verglas on the rock-band up to Earnslaw an attempt of Sir William became the preferred objective. It was rough with slippery loose icy rock and so travel was slow. The route sidles up and around round O'Leary Peak to Luncheon Col and then down to Shepherd's Pass. Nina and Mike headed back to the Bivy and decided to do a recce of the route up to Earnslaw for the next day. We found verglas on the first rock band and without a rope did not proceed any further. Kevin and Russell returned mid-afternoon after calling it a day on Sir William. The Francis Glacier was badly cut-up and has receded so much that the exposed rock had destabilised. To climb it would require a descent to 1600-1700m to acquire the ridge with more stable rock. This would mean a long day (800m of descent then 1000m of ascent) so the quest for the peak was abandoned at 10.30am about 100m below Shepherds Pass. It is possibly easier to climb from the Dart Valley via the Bedford.

## **Day Four: East Peak Earnslaw Climb**

TODAY WAS PROBABLY THE highlight of the trip and as predicted by our weather maestro (Kevin) a perfect day. It was a straightforward climb involving two scree

band two rock bands in tandem and then a scramble to the summit. Some remaining verglas meant a short pitch on the first rock band was necessary. The second rock band involved an initial steep gully which was still frozen, and necessitated two further pitches. There is a fixed anchor point at the top of the gully to rappel off. From then on the route continues through the rock band and was mainly straightforward rock scrambling up through a system of ledges following a well-marked cairned route to the next scree slope and then up to the summit. There is a bit of exposure but plenty of good foot and hand holds and we did not require further use of the rope as the ice had now mostly melted. We had the luxury of an hour on the summit but sadly also caught up with the news of the extent of the deaths in Christchurch. The route down was fast and straightforward with the ice now melted, but an abseil into fresh air off an overhanging rock was not my favourite part of the trip!

## **Day Five: Slave driver**

THE CONSTRAINT OF MY flight-time from Queenstown at 4.00pm meant our trip out was somewhat pressured, so we were up at 4.00am and away by 5.30.

The route across the glacier involved some tricky navigation and we were spotted from below creating an interesting series of figure of eights with our headlamps. The glacier cracked like a gunshot at frequent intervals which was a bit unnerving. A bit of remaining verglas on the lower rock band slowed progress slightly. Kevin and

Nina raced on ahead for her flight while Mike and Russell took a more leisurely stroll out. I think Kevin saw the march out as a personal challenge (so did my feet) however we were able to catch up together in Queenstown.

Thanks to Kevin for the logistics and to Mike, Russell, and Kevin for being such good mates over the five days. Scottish climbers make nice porridge too!



# Upcoming Club Trips

## Wellington Section Trips

Trips are a key part of the Wellington Section. Trips can be of any length, any level of difficulty, and any size. Simply email us or approach us at the monthly meeting, and we can help you get going. Send your trip ideas, no matter how vague, to [trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz](mailto:trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz)

And remember we love to hear about your trips – send stories to [newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz](mailto:newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz)

## Kawakawa Bay, Taupo

**Date:** 13-15 May

**Trip coordinator:** TBA

**Level:** Rock grades 16+

TREAT YOURSELF TO EXCELLENT TRAD and sport climbing on some quality rock at Kawakawa Bay, Taupo. Great rock, multipitch routes, and a wide range of grades

make this a great location – and having the largest lake in the North Island as a backdrop won't hurt. Leave Friday (yes, we can stop for a kebab in Bulls) and then you can yank those holds Saturday and Sunday until the cow comes home or your arms give out, whatever comes first. Contact Hinrich at 021 298 6894 or by email at [h.schaefer@niwa.co.nz](mailto:h.schaefer@niwa.co.nz)



Kawakawa Bay - image courtesy of Vincent Zintzen

## Mt. Paske: weekend trip to the Nelson Lakes

**Date:** 2-3 April

**Trip coordinator:** TBA

**Experience:** AIC and 0-3 years of mountaineering

WHY WASTE TIME WAITING for one of those elusive statutory holidays when the Nelson Lakes offer objectives that can be done in a weekend. From the headwaters of Rainbow River past Rainbow Station

to Rainbow Hut and down to Rainbow junction: surely all this rainbow business means that the sun will break through in time on Sunday for an alpine start from Paske Hut to climb the peak by the South East Ridge. Short and sweet and better than being stuck in Wellington for the weekend.

Contact Hinrich at 04 386 0316 or [h.schaefer@niwa.co.nz](mailto:h.schaefer@niwa.co.nz)

## Easter trip to the Warrior in the Armoury Range

**Date:** 22-25 April

**Trip coordinator:** TBA

**Experience:** AIC and 1-3 years of mountaineering

THIS YEAR WE WILL take advantage of the Easter break for a trip to the Armoury Range. The first day is travel to Erehon Station west of Christchurch and a hike up the Clyde River to McCoy Hut. The next day will see the push for the main objective: the War-

rior. For those with spare energy and curiosity there should be spare time the following day to explore the McCoy Valley. Walk out in the afternoon/evening and travel home the next day. This trip is geared to those willing to do a stiff approach walk and confident in their mountaineering skills to experience this outstanding scenery.

Contact Hinrich at 04 386 0316 or by email at [h.schaefer@niwa.co.nz](mailto:h.schaefer@niwa.co.nz)



# Notices

## Siberia Hut Burnt Down

THE POPULAR SIBERIA HUT on the Gillespie Pass Circuit Track in Mt Aspiring National Park burnt to the ground on 16 March. The cause of the fire is currently unknown. There were no injuries to trampers in the hut. For further details contact Paul Hellebrekers on 027 222 4139.

## FMC Video Competition

THE INAUGURAL FMC VIDEO Competition is being held this year. Details are available on the Video Competition Page (<http://www.fmc.org.nz/services-to-clubs/videocomp/>).

## Rock Wren Sightings

IF YOU HAVE RECENTLY tramped, or are planning on tramping in the South Island's alpine areas over the remainder of the summer period, you may be able to assist researchers from the University of Otago with a Rock Wren survey. Reports of any recent sightings anywhere in the South Island would be greatly appreciated. Rock Wrens are small birds (10



Photo: Pete McGregor

cm) with almost no tail, have very high-pitched calls and often bob up and down. They are poor fliers and are usually found amongst boulder fields, scree and low scrub in open alpine areas.

Please send details (location, grid or map ref, # of birds) to: Kerry Weston, Department of Zoology, University of Otago. Email: [kerry-anne.weston@otago.ac.nz](mailto:kerry-anne.weston@otago.ac.nz)

## Six Month Membership Extension

THE WINNER OF NZAC's six month membership extension for March is (Anna) Nien-tzu Ma of the

Auckland Section. Renew your membership when it is due to be in with a chance to win.

## Hut Renovations

NZAC is currently in the midst of a busy post-summer huts capital programme, which means a number are temporarily closed – here are the details:

- Unwin Lodge, Aoraki Mt Cook National Park: after all the years of planning and fundraising, construction of the new bunkroom wing is about to begin. Unwin is now officially closed until the end of September.
- Colin Todd Hut, Mt Aspiring National Park: the weather has not quite cooperated with the construction team, so this hut remains closed. We expect the recladding work to be complete by mid April.
- Whangaehu Hut, Tongariro National Park: the recladding and window replacement project on this hut is partially completed, so this hut remains closed until further notice.

A huge thanks to all the club volunteers and DOC staff who are making all these projects possible, and a reminder to all hut users that paying your hut fees does make a huge difference to the club.

Any questions relating to the above huts & projects, see the NZAC website or feel free to contact NZAC national office: [office@alpineclub.org.nz](mailto:office@alpineclub.org.nz)

Those involved in renovations to Whangaehu Hut are looking for some help, particularly from people who have some building / renovation skills and are available in late March / early April. There may be an opportunity to make a long weekend of it and there may be a helicopter available to assist with lifting of tools.

So if you can help, give Richard Knott a ring on 027 348 6657, or email [richard.knott@xtra.co.nz](mailto:richard.knott@xtra.co.nz)

# Tukino Lodge – Acquire Member Privileges

THE NEW ZEALAND ALPINE Club have been working with the Tukino Alpine Sports Club to secure member privileges to their lodge at Tukino Skifield on the eastern side of Mt Ruapehu. A number of New Zealand Alpine Club supporters have each contributed \$2,000 each to acquire these privileges.

We have almost got our full complement of financial supporters, but we are still a few short of our target. These financial supports also attract some personal privileges from their contribution. If you can't make this amount, smaller donations are welcome.

Tukino is a fantastic spot. There are very few areas in NZ where you can dive to within a few minutes' walk of high class ice climbs. The ski-touring is brilliant, and there is an impressive amount of rock waiting to be climbed over the summer months, all within minutes from the lodge door. The lodge is a good base for

the trek up to the clubs Whangaehu hut. Being able to drive to the lodge door makes it an ideal base for family groups. And of course there is the un-crowded ski field for the winter entertainment. Tukino definitely earns its name as "the wild side" mainly because of its untouched and uncrowded nature.

If you can't help financially we are also looking for a few people to help with the maintenance program, like plumbers, builders and experts with paint brushes or shovels. We even would like some administrators. Have a look at the Tukino Alpine Sports Club website at <http://tukinoalpinestportsclub.org.nz/>. By the way, the hut is available for hire over the summer months to NZAC members at \$15.00pp.

If you can help contact Don French at [don.f@xtra.co.nz](mailto:don.f@xtra.co.nz), or on 027 445 2980 / 06 377 7117

## Wellington Section 2011/12 contacts list

| Position                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Name                       | Email alias*     | Phone                                                                |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Chairperson                                                                                                                                                                                                   | James Wright               | chairperson      | 027 472 5561                                                         |
| Vice Chair                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Scott Taylor               | vicechair        |                                                                      |
| Secretary                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Catherine Moger            | secretary or CM2 | 04 973 1307 (h), or 021 079 0854                                     |
| Treasurer                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Matt Knarston              | treasurer        |                                                                      |
| National Rep                                                                                                                                                                                                  | James Wright               | JW               | 027 472 5561                                                         |
| Patron                                                                                                                                                                                                        | John Nankervis             |                  |                                                                      |
| Trips                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Hinrich Schaefer           | Trips            |                                                                      |
| Other Committee Members                                                                                                                                                                                       | Richard Davies             | RD               |                                                                      |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Matt Knarston              | MK               |                                                                      |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Steve Minchin              | SM               |                                                                      |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Lorraine Johns             | LJ               |                                                                      |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Hinrich Schaefer           | HS               |                                                                      |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Rebecca Thomson            | RT               |                                                                      |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Vincent Zintzen            | VZ               |                                                                      |
| Other Roles:                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                            |                  |                                                                      |
| Gear                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Marcus Manning             | gear             |                                                                      |
| Personal Locator Beacons                                                                                                                                                                                      | Hinrich Schaefer           | PLB              |                                                                      |
| Instruction Convenor                                                                                                                                                                                          | Vacant                     |                  |                                                                      |
| Instruction - AIC                                                                                                                                                                                             | Vacant                     |                  |                                                                      |
| Instruction - Rock                                                                                                                                                                                            | Blair Hiscoke              | summerrock or BH |                                                                      |
| Library                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Derek Richardson           | library          |                                                                      |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Peter Shanahan             | PS2              |                                                                      |
| Newsletter Editor                                                                                                                                                                                             | Steve Minchin              | newsletter or SM |                                                                      |
| Rock Drill Overseer                                                                                                                                                                                           | Kristen Foley              | drill or KF      |                                                                      |
| Website                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Richard Thomson            | webmaster        |                                                                      |
| * Email address is: <a href="mailto:alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz">alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz</a> eg. <a href="mailto:secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz">secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz</a> |                            |                  |                                                                      |
| Any membership, Distaghil Sar Fund, or general queries should be directed to the secretary                                                                                                                    |                            |                  |                                                                      |
| Any media queries should be directed to:                                                                                                                                                                      |                            |                  |                                                                      |
| 03 3777 595                                                                                                                                                                                                   | National Executive Officer | Ollie Clifton    | <a href="mailto:ollie@alpineclub.org.nz">ollie@alpineclub.org.nz</a> |





Shed 6 Queens Wharf  
Wellingtons Waterfront  
Ph 04 4998898 Fax 04 4998896  
wn@fergskayaks.co.nz  
www.fergskayaks.co.nz

Open 7 Days

Largest Real Rock Indoor Rock Wall – Kayaking – Inline Skates - Retail - Rental

Alpine Club members can climb any time for \$10  
Monday nights show your Alpine Club card and climb for \$8

Do you remember  
the rush of a new route?

Better routes  
Less Crowds  
Friendly Atmosphere  
Better Bouldering  
Did I mention better routes?  
Least importantly: \$10 everynight, \$8 Monday for NZAC  
We are the community Climbing Gym

Come to HangDog!



**HangDog Rock Climbing  
Adventures**

453 Hutt Rd  
Lower Hutt  
(04) 589 9181  
www.hangdog.co.nz  
info@hangdog.co.nz

i climb.co.nz

" I used Maxim Unity halves on  
the first ascent of Vitalogy  
on the SE Buttress of  
Mt Bradley in Alaska.  
Very durable, light,  
and easy-handling.  
A really wonderful rope. "

- Graham Zimmerman



Half ropes  
Unity 8mm x 50m STD-DRY TPT **\$205**  
Unity 8mm x 50m 2X-DRY TPT **\$270**  
Unity 8mm x 60m 2X-DRY TPT **\$320**  
Unity 9mm x 60m 2X-DRY **\$330**

Single ropes  
Equinox 10.2mm x 60m STD-DRY **\$230**  
Glider 9.9mm x 60m 2X-DRY TPT **\$360**  
Pinnacle 9.5mm x 60m 2X-DRY TPT **\$360**

Dry treatments and TPT (reduced rope drag)  
are detailed at [www.iclimb.co.nz](http://www.iclimb.co.nz)

*Maxim Ropes,  
climbing brand of New England Ropes, USA*

If undelivered please return to:

NZAC Wellington Section  
PO Box 1628  
Wellington

